

Glossary

atmosphere Mass of air that surrounds the Earth

attraction Force that pulls things together. The opposite ends (poles) of two magnets attract each other

bacteria Tiny one-celled creatures found all around us. Some bacteria are good, but others cause disease

carbohydrate Along with fats and proteins, energy-rich carbohydrates, such as sugar and starch, are one of the three major food groups

carnivore Animal that eats only meat. Lions, wolves, sharks, and crocodiles are carnivores

carrion Remains of dead animals that other animals eat

chlorophyll Pigment in plants that traps the energy of sunlight for photosynthesis and gives them their green color

circuit Loop that an electric current travels around

compound Chemical made when two or more elements are joined by a chemical reaction

continent One of the Earth's huge landmasses, like Asia. There are seven continents

electromagnet Powerful magnet created by a flow of electricity through a coil

endorphins Chemicals released by the brain that make you feel happy and reduce pain

erosion Wearing down of rock by water or the weather

estuary Wide part of a river where it meets the sea

fertilization Process in which the male and female parts of an animal or plant join together to reproduce

force Push or a pull. Gravity is the force that keeps you on the ground

fossil fuels Fuels that come from the earth and are the remains of living things. Coal, oil, and natural gas are all fossil fuels

genes Chemical instructions in your cells, holding the information that makes you who you are

global warming Slow rise in average temperatures around the world, believed to be caused by the greenhouse effect

greenhouse effect When the atmosphere traps in heat, the Earth becomes warm enough for life to thrive

habitat Area where a particular species of plant, fungus, or animal lives

herbivore Animal that eats only plants. Cows, koalas, and elephants are herbivores

invertebrates Animals that don't have a backbone

laboratory Place where scientists carry out their experiments

